Anish
Rao

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer with 3 years building for DraftKings' casino platforms across 7 regulated US and Canadian markets. Owned third-party game integration end to end as sole technical contact for 20+ vendors, scaling delivery from ~150 to 500+ games per sprint with Python automation, alongside core .NET/C# and SQL backend services powering the casino web and mobile apps, shipped with zero rollbacks. Promoted twice and commended by DraftKings engineering leadership for the Golden Nugget launch. Now building production AI voice systems. M.Sc. Data Analytics, First Class Honours.

KEY SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: C#, .NET, Python, SQL, Django, Xamarin, REST APIs, NUnit, Moq
Databases & Messaging: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka
Cloud & DevOps: Azure Pipelines (CI/CD), Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Bamboo, Docker, AWS S3, DataDog
AI & LLM: Multi-provider LLM, speech-to-text and text-to-speech pipelines, MCP, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot
Delivery: Agile/Scrum, UAT, Requirements and Acceptance Criteria, Vendor Management, JIRA, Confluence

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer (Contract), *HR-tech company, AI voice recruiting products (Freelance)* Oct 2026 – Present

- Build features with an India-based team for an AI voice recruiter that phones and screens job candidates, using Python, FastAPI, React, Redis and LiveKit.
- Shipped real-time failure alerting across 9 AI providers including OpenAI, Gemini, Deepgram and ElevenLabs, so outages are caught before candidates notice, using Slack, Redis and a React admin panel, with unit tests in vitest.
- Redesigned the partner platform's dashboard in React and TypeScript, including light/dark themes and admin screens for partners, organisations and voice library, and delivered fixes on the hiring platform, using Claude Code agentic workflows.

Software Engineer, *TestingXperts (Client: DraftKings)* Oct 2021 – Jul 2024

- Owned the game release pipeline for DraftKings Casino and Golden Nugget across 7 regulated US and Canadian markets, on a platform with 2.7M+ monthly paying customers, releasing games from 20+ vendors on web, iOS and Android.
- Automated vendor asset preparation with Python scripts that mapped, renamed and configured files per market and flagged known issues, scaling releases from ~150 to 500+ games per sprint, with assets deployed to AWS S3 via Bamboo.
- Built core .NET/C# backend services and MySQL data for game launch, lobby and promotions, including real-money versus free-credit tracking for regulatory reporting, payouts and finance, with REST APIs, NUnit/Moq tests and zero rollbacks.
- Debugged live production incidents, including Kafka game-round event issues, and fixed a recurring iOS game-download failure with a .NET caching solution, cutting download errors by 20%+ in DataDog.
- Served as sole technical contact for game vendors, QA, operations and marketing, building a Confluence knowledge base of known issues that cut clarification calls by ~50% with zero escalations.
- Refactored a legacy internal Django tool used by 1,000+ staff, removing duplicate code and adding features, and built scheduled weekly reports for managers up to CEO, saving PMs ~2 hours a day.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Customer Advisor (Part-Time), B&Q, Ireland May 2025 – Present

- Advise 40+ customers a day on technical products, explaining options in plain terms and turning vague needs into clear requirements and the right solution.
- Trained new starters and was recognised by store management for exceptional customer service.

KEY PROJECTS

NYC Taxi Operations Analytics

- Built an automated ETL pipeline that validated 2.8M+ taxi trips, loading 95% into a SQL Server star-schema warehouse and rejecting malformed records, with Tableau and SSRS reporting on KPIs across 266 zones.
- **Tools Used:** SQL Server, SSIS, SSRS, Tableau, Neo4j

Cross-Industry Churn Prediction with Explainable AI (M.Sc. Dissertation)

- Built and compared six ML models to predict telecom and insurance churn, explaining each prediction with SHAP in an interactive Streamlit app; correctly identified 64% of insurance customers who left
- **Tools Used:** Python, SHAP, Streamlit

EDUCATION

Dublin Business School, Ireland, M.Sc. Data Analytics, First Class Honours — Jan 2025 – Feb 2026

Amity University, India, B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering — Jun 2017 – Dec 2021

ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

Written Commendation, Senior Engineering Manager, DraftKings — 2024

- Cited as key to the Golden Nugget Online Gaming launch in West Virginia and Michigan, for independently running the casino game integration and vendor and Casino Ops discussions as the sole engineer.

Action Champion Award, TestingXperts — 2023

- Company-wide award for consistently working beyond the defined scope of the role.

Two Promotions in 12 Months, TestingXperts — 2022

- Promoted from Graduate Engineer Trainee to Associate Software Engineer (Mar 2022), then to Software Engineer

Young Achiever Award, TestingXperts — 2022

- Company-wide award for strong early performance and positive client feedback, received as an Associate Software Engineer.

CERTIFICATIONS

Data Analytics Professional, Google (Coursera) | — 2026

Advanced Tableau, Udemy | — 2021

Statistics for Data Science & Business Analytics, Udemy | — 2021

Python Certification, NPTEL — 2019

Forward Leadership & Problem Solving, McKinsey | — 2025

Claude 101, Anthropic — 2026

Power BI, Udemy | — 2025